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ARTISTS AND ENTERTAINERS



LATEST NEWS: Full UK ETA Enforcement Announced for February 2026 (<https://immigrationbarrister.co.uk/full-uk-eta-enforcen>

LOCATION: HOME ([HTTPS://IMMIGRATIONBARRISTER.CO.UK/](https://immigrationbarrister.co.uk/)) » ...

ARTISTS AND ENTERTAINERS

The UK is a world-leading hub for the creative industries. Whether you are an actor, musician, dancer or other performing artist, our immigration barristers in Covent Garden are well versed in the full range of UK visas available to artists and entertainers who wish to visit or work in the UK.

UK Visas & Immigration Routes for Artists and Entertainers

In order to undertake activities as an artist or entertainer in the UK, you will normally need to obtain a visa under one of the tiers of the points-based system. The points-based system has special categories and rules for those in the creative and entertainment industries. In most categories you will need to be sponsored by an employer. However, if you are going to be in the UK briefly, or for a single event or activity, one of the visitor visa categories may be more appropriate.

The main immigration routes available to artists and entertainers are:

- Creative Visitor (<https://immigrationbarrister.co.uk/personal-immigration/short-stay-visit-visas/creative-visit-visa/>)
- Permitted Paid Engagement (<https://immigrationbarrister.co.uk/personal-immigration/short-stay-visit-visas/permitted-paid-engagement-visit-visa/>)
- Global Talent (<https://immigrationbarrister.co.uk/personal-immigration/global-talent-visas/global-talent-visa-arts-and-culture/>)
- Skilled Worker (<https://immigrationbarrister.co.uk/personal-immigration/long-term-work-visas/skilled-worker-visa/>)
- Temporary Work – Creative Worker (<https://immigrationbarrister.co.uk/personal-immigration/short-term-work-visas/temporary-work-creative-worker-visa/>)



Download Our Guide To

immigration barristers

(L) Immigration Routes For Artists And Entertainers

And Entertainers

Employers and event organisers: if you are a UK organisation and are looking to employ an individual to work in the UK, you may need to sponsor them, unless they are only coming for a short period or they are eligible to come to the UK on a different basis which provides them with permission to work. To sponsor an employee, you will need to obtain a sponsor licence. If the individual will not actually be working for you then they may be eligible for a Standard Visitor visa or a Permitted Paid Engagement visa.

Festivals and Cultural Events: if you organise a festival or cultural event, it will be much easier and cheaper for your performers to enter the UK if your event is on the Home Office's list of permit free festivals. If your event is on the list then your performers will be able to enter the UK with a Standard Visitor visa and you will not be required to sponsor them under the points based system. They will also be able to be paid. To be included on the list, your event must have been established for at least 3 years, have had an audience of at least 15,000 at each of the last 3 festivals and expect to have an audience of at least 15,000 during the course of the next event.

How Our Immigration Barristers Can Help

Our specialist immigration barristers work closely with creative and entertainment sector professionals, employers and event organisers across the film, television, music, performing arts and fashion industries to ensure that their immigration and visa requirements are met.

WE CAN ALSO ASSIST WITH

Applications for Creative Visitor Visas



Applications for Permitted Paid Engagement Visas



Applications for Global Talent Visas

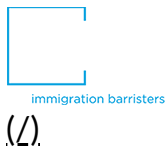


Applications for Skilled Worker Visas



Applications for Temporary Work – Creative Worker Visas





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WHAT CAN WE HELP YOU WITH?

To arrange an initial consultation meeting with a member of our Artists and Entertainers visa team, contact our immigration barristers on 020 3617 9173 or complete our enquiry form.

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LATEST ARTICLES EXPERT COMMENT AND INSIGHT FROM OUR IMMIGRATION TEAM

How to Apply for a UK Creative Worker Visa

<https://immigrationbarrister.co.uk/how-to-apply-for-a-uk-creative-worker-visa/>

By Emilia Cieslak - Legal Associate

21 Dec 2022

Here at Richmond Chambers we are very lucky to be surrounded by some of the best cultural venues the UK has to offer. There's literally an opera house just down the road! If you want to work within the UK's bustling...

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What is work? Complying with your visa conditions

<https://immigrationbarrister.co.uk/what-is-work-complying-with-your-visa-conditions/>

By Gillian McCall - Barrister Partner

13 Oct 2022

Under the Immigration Rules, many people have restrictions on their right to work in the UK. This article will look at some of the main definitions of work used in the Immigration rules in the main work and study...

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Creative Work Visit Routes for Non-visa and EU Nationals

(<https://immigrationbarrister.co.uk/creative-work-visit-routes-for-non-visa-and-eu-nationals/>)

By Georgina Griggs Immigration Barrister

04 Jul 2022

Working in the UK has become more difficult for Europeans following Brexit. EU citizens now, like other non-visa nationals, have to consider what visa options are available for working in the UK. This post will...

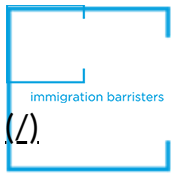
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More ([uk-immigration-law-blog/](https://immigrationbarrister.co.uk/creative-work-visit-routes-for-non-visa-and-eu-nationals/))

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